Changling Li (李常凌)

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LinkedIn | GitHub | Google Scholar | X

"And now I see with eye serene, the very pulse of the machine." – William Wordsworth

Research Interest

AI Safety · AI Governance · Multi-Agent Systems · Reinforcement Learning

Education

- **Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems** *starting 2026 (expected, currently on leave)*
  PhD Student Tübingen, Germany
  - Supervisor: Maksym Andriushchenko and Rediet Abebe
- **ETH Zürich** *Sept 2022 - June 2026*
  Master of Science in Computer Science Zurich, Switzerland
  - Grade: 5.41/6
  - Major: Machine Intelligence; Minor: Theoretical Computer Science
- **Colby College** *Sept 2018 - May 2022*
  Bachelor of Arts in Physics (Astrophysics) and Computer Science with Honors Maine, United States
  - GPA: 3.99/4 (Top 5%, Distinction in both majors)
- **Li Po Chun United World College** *Sept 2016 - June 2018*
  International Baccalaureate Bilingual Diploma Hong Kong
  - Grade: 41/45

Publications

*=Equal Contribution, C=Conference, J=Journal, S=In Submission

[S.1] **Changling Li**, Terry Jingchen Zhang, Jie Zhang, Zhijing Jin, Florian Tramèr, Sahar Abdelnabi, Maksym Andriushchenko. "**Decomposing and Measuring Evaluation Awareness.**" *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.23055.*, 2026.

[C.4] David Guzman Piedrahita, **Changling Li**, Dave Banerjee, Terry Zhang, Kevin Blin, Samuel Simko, Punya Pandey, Irene Strauss, Rada Mihalcea, Bernhard Schölkopf, Zhijing Jin. "**Position: Safe Models Do Not Guarantee Safe Societies.**" *Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning.* (**ICML Spotlight**), 2026.

[C.3] Choi Younwoo*, **Changling Li***, Yongjin Yang, and Zhijing Jin. "**Agent-to-Agent Theory of Mind: Testing Interlocutor Awareness among Large Language Models.**"*Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing* (**EMNLP Main**), 2025.

[C.2] **Changling Li**, Zhang-Wei Hong, Pulkit Agrawal, Divyansh Garg, and Joni Pajarinen. "**ROER: Regularized Optimal Experience Replay.**"*Reinforcement Learning Conference* (**RLC**), 2024.

[J.1] **Changling Li**, Ying Li. "**Scaling up Energy-Aware Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning for Mission-Oriented Drone Networks with Individual Reward.**" *IEEE Internet of Things Journal* (**IoT-J**), 2024.

[C.1] Ying Li, **Changling Li**, Jiyao Chen, and Christine Roinou. "**Energy-Aware Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning for Collaborative Execution in Mission-Oriented Drone Networks.**" In *2022 International Conference on Computer Communications and Networks* (**ICCCN**), pp. 1–9. IEEE, 2022.

Grants, Awards & Scholarships

Research: FAR AI travel grant; Future of Life Institute travel grant; Cooperative AI sponsorship; Coefficient Giving sponsorship.
Undergrad Honors: Distinction in both majors; Magna Cum Laude (top 5%); Phi Beta Kappa; Sigma Pi Sigma; UWC Davis Scholar; Dean's List F'18, S'19, F'19, F'21 (2020 and S'21 - cancelled due to COVID-19).
Colby College Institutional Grant: 45,065$/year × 4 years undergraduate scholarship (90% scholarship, acceptance rate < 5%), Colby College, 2018 - 2022.
UWC Davis Scholarship: 20,000$/year × 4 years undergraduate scholarship, Davis UWC Scholars, 2018 - 2022.
UWC National Committee Scholarship: HKD 278,000/year × 2 years high school scholarship (full scholarship, acceptance rate < 1%), United World College, 2016 - 2018.

Academic Service

- **Trustworthy AI for Good Workshop at ICML 2026 NeurIPS 2026, Co-organizer**, 2026.
- **European Workshop on Reinforcement Learning, Reviewer**, 2026.
- **Reinforcement Learning Conference, Technical Reviewer**, 2025, 2026.

Teaching Experience

- **Teaching Assistant** *Sept 2019 - May 2022*
  Department of Computer Science, Colby College [🌐]
  - Courses: CS 353 Interactive System; CS 251 Data Analysis and Visualization; CS 231 Data Structure and Algorithm; CS 152 Computational Thinking: Science; CS 151 Computational Thinking: Visual Media.
- **Teaching Assistant** *Sept 2019 - May 2021*
  Department of Physics and Astronomy, Colby College [🌐]
  - Courses include: PH 241 Modern Physics I; PH 242 Modern Physics II.

Skills & Interests

- **Programming Languages:** Python, C++, Java.
- **Frameworks:** PyTorch, JAX, TensorFlow, Sklearn, Git, SQL, JSONiq.
- **Domains:** AI, Machine Learning, Reinforcement Learning, Multi-Agent Systems, AI Governance, Ethics.
- **Natural Languages:** English (Native), Mandarin (Native), Spanish (Intermediate), German (Elementary).
- **Interests:** Play Squash, Horror Film, Visual Arts, Scuba Diving.

References

Upon request